

The computer

English inventor and mathematician, Charles Babbage famously designed three computing machines. Their purpose was to store and process numbers and output the results of calculations. Babbage's designs were groundbreaking, leading many to regard him as the "father of the computer."



Part of Babbage's "Difference Engine No. 1"

EARLY COMPUTING

The era of modern computing began during World War II. In 1941, German engineer Konrad Zuse completed the Z3, the world's first general-purpose digital computer, which was nonelectronic and large enough to fill a room. It helped Zuse in his calculations for aeronautical design.

► COMPUTING GIANT

The Colossus was a computer developed by the British in 1943–1945 during World War II to assist in breaking Germany's wartime secret codes.



BILL GATES

Every computer uses software—a set of instructions that tells a computer how to perform a task. In 1975, US computer scientist Bill Gates cofounded Microsoft, which became the world's largest software company and made him one of the world's richest men.

